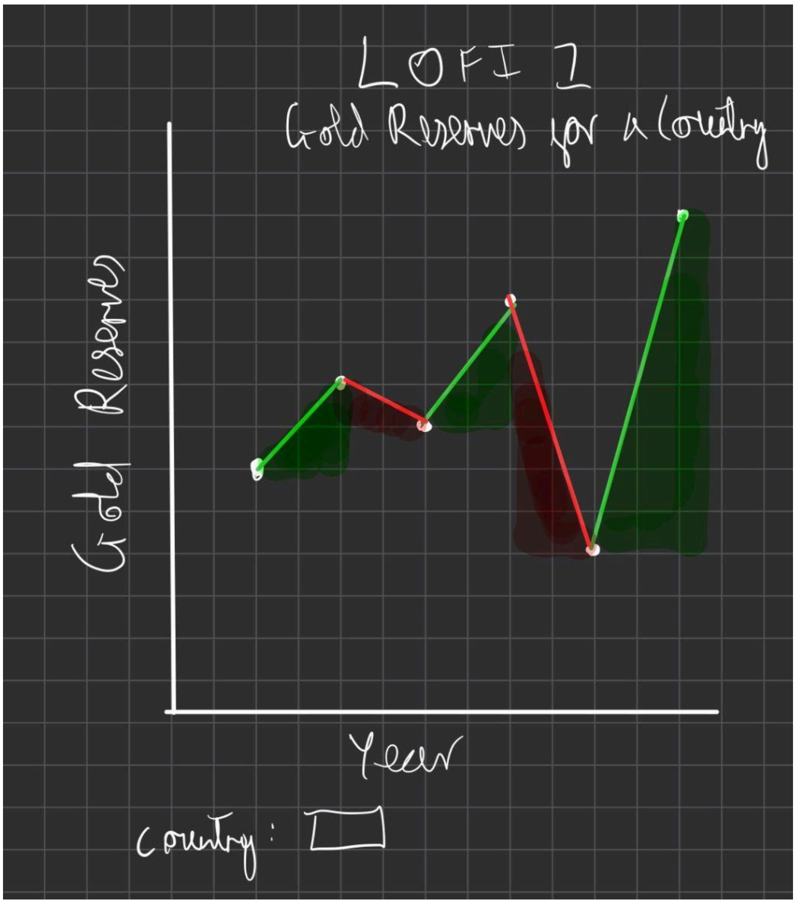
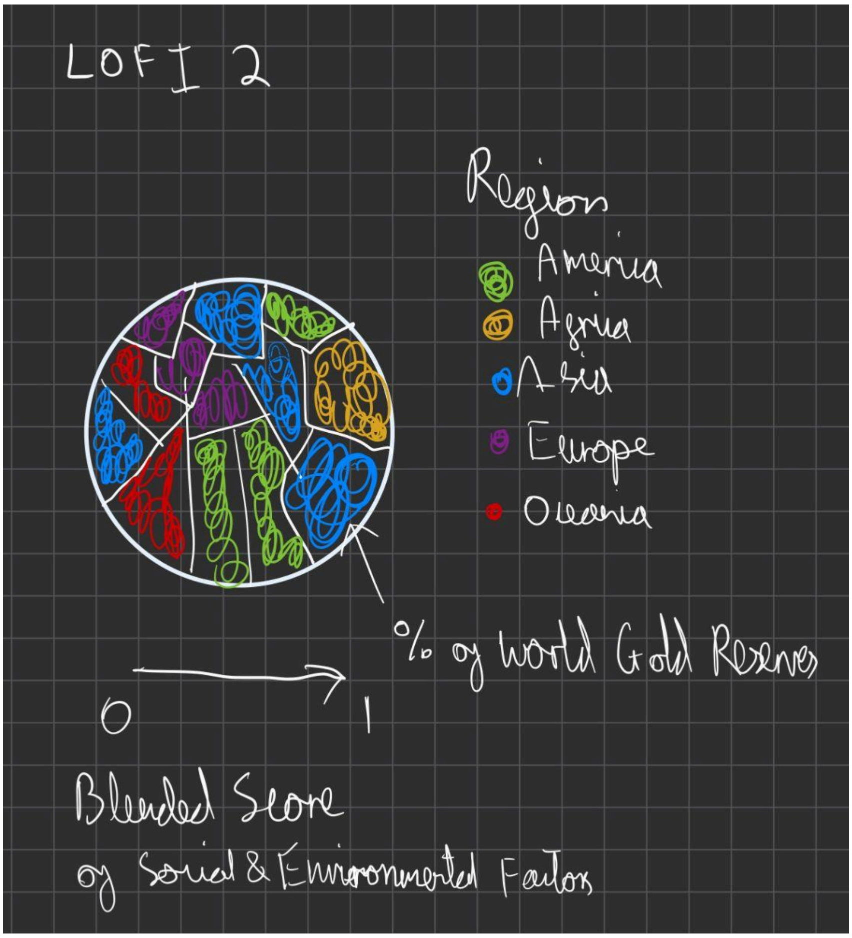
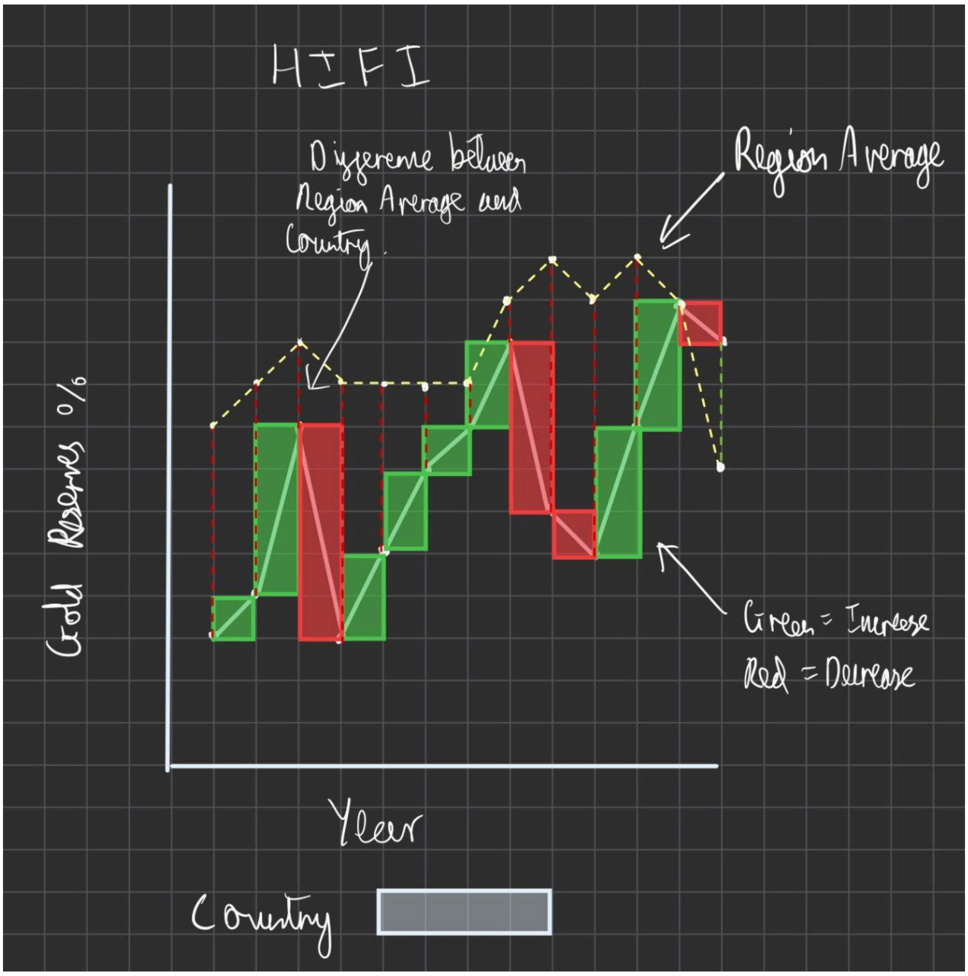

LOFI 1
Gold Reserves for a Country
Gold Reserves
Year
Country:


LOFI 2
Region
America
Africa
Asia
Europe
Oceania
% of world Gold Reserves
0
1
Blended Score
of Social & Environmental Factors



My novel visualization compares a selected country's gold reserves over time to the regional average, highlighting both the direction and the magnitude of change year by year. I designed it to reveal patterns that are not visible in traditional line charts, especially the gaps between the country and its region. This helps users quickly understand whether a country is outperforming, underperforming, or moving in sync with its broader region.

To communicate these differences clearly, I used bars to represent the country's year to year change in reserves. Green bars indicate increases, while red bars indicate decreases. This color encoding allows viewers to immediately see periods of growth or decline without needing to interpret slopes or numerical labels. On top of the bars, I added a soft diagonal highlight to emphasize the direction of the change. Bars are positioned along a continuous x axis for years, making it easy to follow the timeline.

The regional average is shown as a dotted yellow line that runs across the chart. I used a line mark instead of bars because the regional trend serves as a reference rather than a primary value. The dashed style visually separates it from the main data while still allowing clear comparison. Small white points mark each year's regional average to add clarity and help guide the eye.

The spacing between the bars and the regional line encodes the difference between the country values and the regional benchmark. I highlighted one of these gaps with an annotation to make the meaning explicit. The difference encoding is the key insight of the visualization, enabling users to understand not just the direction of change but how far the country deviates from regional norms.

Overall, I chose these design elements to create an intuitive comparison between country performance and regional context, focusing on clarity, visual storytelling, and interpretability without relying on standard chart libraries.